

AI PRODUCT STRATEGY

**Your buyer can
build it now.
In three minutes.**

Open a chat assistant. Describe the problem you solve.
See what comes back.

That result is your new baseline. Not a threat. A test.

The old moat is gone.

- Two years ago, building a working AI workflow required real technical effort. The buyer could not replicate it. That gap was the product.
- That gap is narrower now. A buyer who can describe their own problem can get a working version in a single session.
- The clever prompt sequence is not a moat. Prompts travel. The model is not a moat. Models are a commodity.

If what you built is a spreadsheet wearing a nicer shirt, you should know that before your next sales call.

THE TEST

Run the three-minute baseline on your own offer.

Describe the workflow in plain language

Not your marketing copy. The honest description: what goes in, what comes out, what the system decides.

Look at the output to find the gap

Not to be relieved or panicked. The gap is where your defensibility lives.

The test is not a verdict. It is a map.

WHAT THEY ARE BUYING

Buyers are not paying for the output.

They can approximate the output now.

They know it. You know it. What they are paying for is not wanting to own it.

The ongoing execution. The maintenance when the upstream tool updates. The judgment call when the edge case falls outside the spec.

THE COMPLEXITY THRESHOLD

Getting started is not the expensive part. Staying correct is.

- Below the threshold: self-serve is good enough. Your moat is distribution or habit, not the workflow.
- Above the threshold: complexity compounds. Each integration creates new failure modes. Each use case variation requires judgment.
- The tool that worked in January breaks predictably in July when the upstream spec drifts.

That is where ongoing ownership becomes the product.

WHERE DEFENSIBILITY LIVES

The gap is not in the logic. It is in who owns the ongoing work.

Weak gap: the frontend

Medium gap: the integration

Strong gap: ongoing ownership of correctness, failure response, and judgment on edge cases

Ask your offer: what survives after the buyer generates the obvious version themselves?

THE FOUR STEPS

Running the baseline test on your own offer.

1. Describe the workflow honestly
2. Run it in a chat assistant. See what comes back.
3. Locate the gap: frontend, integration, or ownership model
4. Ask: am I selling toward that gap?

If not, you are selling something buyers can now get for free. And they will figure that out before you do.

full/REFIT

Get the Claude Baseline Test scorecard.

Run the test systematically. Map where your defensibility actually lives. Takes about fifteen minutes once.

Get the free scorecard

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